

“ IF YOU DON'T TRY TO WIN YOU MIGHT AS WELL HOLD THE OLYMPICS IN SOMEBODY'S BACKYARD. ”

Jesse Owens, US athlete, at the Olympic Games, 1936

US athlete Jesse Owens stands on the podium after winning the long jump at the Berlin Olympics. German silver medal winner Lutz Long gives the Nazi salute.

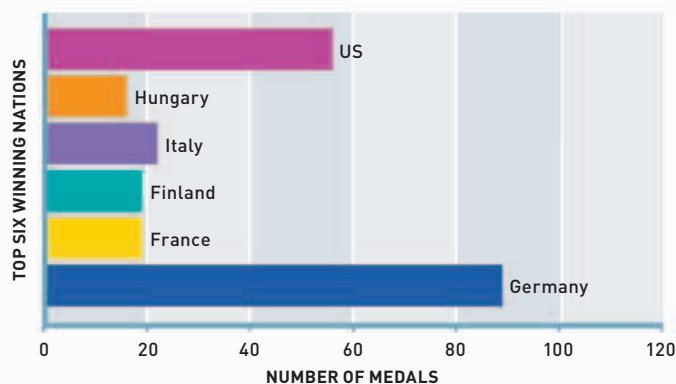
a neutral stance, leaving only the Soviet Union to back the Republic. Franco's Army of Africa advanced inexorably on Madrid, carrying out massacres along the way.

Meanwhile, Comintern was recruiting volunteers from many European countries and North America to fight in Spain. The first of these **International Brigades** played a vital role in the defense



GENERAL FRANCISCO FRANCO (1892–1975)

Franco was a career officer who commanded the Spanish Foreign Legion in Morocco in the 1920s. A Catholic monarchist, he joined the military uprising against the Republic in July 1936 and was recognized as sole leader of the Nationalist rebels in September. After victory in the Civil War in 1939 he imposed a harsh dictatorship. He kept Spain neutral in World War II and remained in power until his death in 1975.



1936 Olympic Games medal tally

The most successful countries in the 1936 Berlin summer Olympics were Germany and the US. The Soviet Union and Spain were among countries that did not take part.

of Madrid in November. The Nationalist advance was halted and Madrid remained Republican.

In the highly charged political atmosphere of 1936, the holding of the summer **Olympic Games** in **Berlin**—agreed to before the Nazis came to power—was inevitably a propaganda coup for Hitler. He seized the opportunity to present the Third Reich in a favorable light. The Olympics were staged on an unprecedentedly lavish scale with impeccable efficiency. Germany topped the medal table, but black American athlete **Jesse Owens** attracted the most attention by winning four gold medals in sprint events and the long jump. Hitler was accused of snubbing Owens because his success ran counter to Nazi theories of Aryan racial superiority. Owens himself felt more insulted by the lack of congratulations from Roosevelt.

The Berlin Olympics were the occasion for the **first live TV broadcasts**. Seventy hours of fuzzy black-and-white coverage were shown in special viewing rooms around the city, as well as picked up by a handful of private TV sets. Later in the year, the BBC began the first regular high-definition television service, broadcast from Alexandra Palace in London.

In the fall, two events took place that would enter Britain's political mythology. The **Jarrow Crusade** was a march by 200 cloth-capped jobless workers from a Depression-blighted shipbuilding town on the Tyne River. Jarrow had 70 percent unemployment. The workers sought to publicize its plight by presenting a petition to parliament in Westminster. Their 280-mile (450-km) journey took almost a month, attracting sympathetic coverage in the

press. Its effect was zero, but it became for the British a symbol of the era of mass unemployment.

On October 4, the black-shirted **British Union of Fascists (BUF)** staged a march through a predominantly Jewish area of London's East End. There they clashed with antifascists in what became known as the **Battle of Cable Street**. The march was abandoned. This humiliation for the BUF was followed by a government ban on political uniforms. British fascism never regained its momentum.

In the US, **Roosevelt** (see 1933) won a landslide victory in the



Marconiphone television receiver
Early televisions like this one made by Marconi were luxury products—the Marconiphone sold in Britain for 60 guineas, equivalent to about \$4,500 (£3,000) today.

325 THE NUMBER OF DAYS EDWARD VIII REIGNED AS KING BEFORE HE ABDICATED

presidential elections in November, securing a second term and confirming the popularity of his New Deal policies.

Three weeks after Roosevelt's reelection, a further critical step toward a new world war was taken when Germany and Japan signed the **Anti-Comintern Pact**. Explicitly an agreement to resist communist subversion, the pact was aimed against the Soviet Union. It created an ideological link between the Nazis and an increasingly militaristic Japan.

On November 16, Britain's king **Edward VIII** (1894–1972) informed Prime Minister Stanley Baldwin that he intended to marry American divorcee **Mrs. Wallis Simpson**. Political opinion was solidly behind Baldwin, who told the king that he must choose between Simpson and the throne. **Edward abdicated** and his brother, Albert, inherited the throne as George VI (1895–1952).

